

Course Overview

Introduction to Psychology | PSY 101 | CRN 21148 | 3 Credits

Department: Psychology

Prerequisites/Corequisites: None

Meeting Times: Online, Asynchronous

Instruction Type: Online Lectures, Recorded Videos

Instructor: David Brocker

Email: Brockeda@farmingdale.edu (mailto:Brockeda@farmingdale.edu)

Phone: 934-420-5678

Office Hours: Monday: 9am-11am | Wednesday: 11am-12pm | Friday - 1pm-3pm

General Education: This course satisfies 3 credits of the Social and Behavioral Science competency area of the General Education requirements at Farmingdale State College.

Catalog Course Description: This course is designed to present basic psychological concepts and to introduce students to the scientific study of behavior. Core topics include methods of psychological research, the biological bases of behavior, principles of learning, memory and cognition, personality, and psychopathology.

Other selected topics to be covered would include the following: motivation and emotion, life-span development, social psychology, health psychology, sensation and perception, intelligence, human sexuality, statistics, and altered states of consciousness.

Credits: 3.0

Course Learning Outcomes:

Upon successful completion of PSY 101, students will be able to:

1. Define psychology and describe the main focus of each major area of applied psychology including clinical, counseling, school, and industrial/organizational psychology.
2. Summarize the major tenants of the various psychological perspectives including the psychodynamic, behavioral, humanistic, cognitive, and biological schools of thought.
3. Outline the steps of the scientific method.
4. Identify the differences between correlational and experimental research methods including the advantages and disadvantages/potential confounds of each.

5. Identify the key functions of the neurotransmitters and brain structures described in the course as they relate to human behavior.
6. Describe the processes of classical and operant conditioning.
7. Describe the key processes of memory including encoding, storage, and retrieval and strategies to enhance these processes to reduce forgetting.
8. Identify the major perspectives on how personality traits develop including the psychodynamic, behavioral, humanistic, and biological perspectives.
9. List the defining symptoms of psychological disorders including anxiety, mood, somatoform, dissociative, personality, and schizophrenic disorders.

Note: Students completing this course may not receive credit for PSY 130 or PSY 131

Required Text:

Psychology: Modules for Active Learning, Custom 15th Edition, Coon, Mitterer, Martini, Cengage Learning (<https://www.cengage.com/c/psychology-modules-for-active-learning-14e-coon/9781305964112PF/>)

Grading

Grading in this class:

Your grade for this class will be out of 650 possible points. The breakdown is described below.

Examinations (400pts): Exams in this class will account for 50% of your final grade.

1st Exam – 100pts

2nd Exam – 100pts

3rd exam - 100pts

Final Exam – 100pts

Quizzes (100pts): There will be 10 quizzes (10pts each) throughout the semester. This quiz will serve as a way for me to see if everyone is doing their readings, and help me adjust my teaching as we go so that everyone is on the same page.

Create a Meme (30pts): For this assignment, you will identify 3 concepts that you have learned and create a meme based on your understanding. This will be based on a rubric.

Discussion Posts (50pts): There will be 5 discussions throughout the semester worth 10 points each. You will be tasked with answering the prompt thoroughly (8pts) and responding to at least 2 classmates (2pts).

Assignments (40pts): There will be 5 assignments throughout the semester that will focus on implementing key ideas discussed in lecture, in real-life situations.

Writing Assignment (30pts): The overall goal of this effort is for you to read an article in a scholarly psychology journal and to write a report on that article. This report is worth 30 points of your final grade.

Grading Breakdown

Minimum Grade Percentage Equivalent	Grade	GPA Equivalent	Interpretation
93.0	A	4.00	Excellent
90.0	A-	3.67	
87.0	B+	3.33	
83.0	B	3.00	Good
80.0	B-	2.67	
77.0	C+	2.33	
73.0	C	2.00	Satisfactory
70.0	C-	1.67	
67.0	D+	1.33	
60.0	D	1.00	Minimum Passing
0	F		Failure
0	I		Incomplete
0	W		Withdrawal
0	UW		Unofficial Withdrawal

Online Guidelines

Lecture materials and assignments will open at the start of the week (Monday) and be due by the end of the week (Friday). You will have one week to read/watch the lecture materials, complete any quizzes, assignments, and tests.

For example: The week of **January 23rd**, you will be expected to read/watch all the materials related to *Introduction to Psychology* by **January 27th**. You will have until 11:59 PM to submit any assignments, quizzes, and tests. Since you will have the week to do this, there will be no exceptions made for late work.

If you have any questions regarding this format, please email me! I will make sure to post several videos as well to help guide you through the course and I am happy to meet you during office hours.

Schedule

Week by week class outline:

[Please Note: The schedule may be modified as needed]

Date	Topic	Student Learning Outcomes	Modules
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Week 1: 1/23-1/27	Introduction to Psychology and Critical Thinking	1. Trace the history of psychology and how it has changed (or stayed the same) over time. 2. Learn about pseudo psychologies and common cognitive biases including uncritical acceptance, confirmation bias, superstition and Barnum effect 3. Define the scientific method, and describe how it applies to psychological research.	[2,3]
Week 2: 1/30-2/3	Research Methods	1. Define the scientific method, and describe how it applies to psychological research. 2. Explain the difference between experimental and nonexperimental psychology. 3. Describe aspects of the experimental method in psychology, including the ability to define terms such as hypothesis, confound, independent and dependent variable	[4,5]
Week 3: 2/6-2/10	Brain and Behavior	1. List and describe the major divisions of the nervous system. 2. Explain how the different parts of the brain are identified 3. Explain how the endocrine system affects behavior.	[7,8,10]
Week 4: 2/13-2/17	Exam 1	Topics Covered: Introduction to Psychology, Research Methods, Brain and Behavior	
Week 5: 2/20-2/24	Human Development	1. Describe how emotions develop from infancy to adulthood 2. Explain how children acquire language. 3. Explain how morality is developed.	[14,15,16]
Week 6: 2/27-3/3	Sensation and Perception	1. Describe how the visual system works. 2. Explain the different mechanisms	[17 ,18 ,19,20,21]

behind chemical senses.

3. Explain how perceptions are constructed, and how they can be altered.

Week 7: 3/6-3/10	Conditioning and Learning	1. Define learning, and list examples of associative learning. 2. Differentiate classical and operant condition and give examples of both.	[27 ,28,29,30]
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Spring Break: 3/13 - 3/18

Week 8 3/20-3/24	Exam 2	Topics Covered: Human Development, Sensation and Perception Conditioning and Learning
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Week 9: 3/27-3/31	Memory	1. Distinguish the differences between short-term, long-term, and sensory memory. 2. Explain the various methods of remembering, and also why we forget. 3. Explain how the brain forms and stores memories	[32,33,34]
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Week 10: 4/3-4/7	Cognition and Intelligence	1. Define language and the role it plays in thinking. 2. Explain some of the various methods of problem solving, and give examples of each. 3. Explain how human intelligence is measured, and whether there are any biases in this measurement.	[37,38,40]
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Week 11: 4/10-4/14	Motivation and Emotion	1. Explain what motivation is and the different types of motives. 2. Describe how arousal is related to motivation. 3. Explain how different emotions are expressed in the face, and if they accurately convey the intended meaning.	[42,43,44]
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Week 12: 4/17-11/21	Exam 3	Topics Covered: Memory, Cognition and Intelligence, Motivation and Emotion
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Week 13: 4/24-4/28	Personality	1. Describe the interactive relationship between heredity and environment in the formation personality (nature & nurture) 2. Explain the differences between the psychodynamic, behavioral, and humanistic views of personality	[51,52,53]
Week 14: 5/1-5/5	Psychological Disorders	1. List and describe the major mental disorders. 2. Explain how mental disorders are diagnosed and how they are caused. 3. Explain and differentiate between the types of mood and personality disorders.	[61,62,63]
Week 15: 5/8	Social Psychology	1. Explain how social situations affect our behavior and cognition. 2. Define social behavior and the concepts of mere presence, conformity, and compliance. 3. Define prosocial behavior and the concepts of familiarity, similarity, physical attraction, and reciprocity. 4. Define prejudice and explain how it is caused.	[65, 66, 67]
Finals Week: TBA	Final Exam	Topics Covered: Personality, Psychological Disorders, Social Psychology	

Policies

Brightspace (/d2l)

Brightspace will be used to post class material and for the submission of assignments. To access the site, please log on to MyFSC and select Brightspace. If you have difficulty accessing the site, please contact the helpdesk:

Email: helpdesk@farmingdale.edu (mailto:helpdesk@farmingdale.edu)

Phone: 934-420-2754.

Handing in Assignments When uploading your final paper, it is your responsibility to ensure the document opens properly and is the correct document that you intended to send.

I will *only* accept Word Documents (which the College Provides (<https://www.farmingdale.edu/information-technology/office365.shtml>))

I will *only* accept submissions through Brightspace.

Cancellation of Classes: Weather and other campus-wide cancellations will be listed on the home page, Facebook (<https://www.facebook.com/farmingdale/>) and Twitter (<https://twitter.com/FarmingdaleSC>) and you can also sign up for RAVE and SUNY Alert. Go to the Rave (<https://apps.apple.com/us/app/rave-guardian/id691246562>) web page and use your Farmingdale user ID and password to enter the site. For SUNY-Alert, please visit the University Police web page. If class needs to be canceled when the campus is open, students will be notified via email.

Attendance Policy: Attendance will be taken at the beginning of every class. Missing classes will negatively impact your ability to grasp the material, but not your grade.

When you miss a class, it is your responsibility to find out what you missed. Please do not send an email asking, "Did I miss anything important?".

Religious Absences: If you are unable to attend class on certain days due to religious beliefs, please consult with your instructor well in advance of the absence so that appropriate accommodation can be made.

Use of Email: It is College policy that instructors and students use the Farmingdale email system or the Brightspace email system to contact one another.

Please compose emails with the class in the subject line and the topic you would like to discuss, for example:

PSY101 - Quiz 3

Please be mindful the time in which you send an email. I will not respond to emails after 7 PM, I will *always* answer emails within 24 hours.

You **must** use your Farmingdale email. I will *not* reply to outside emails.

Copyright Statement: Course material accessed from Brightspace or the Farmingdale website is for the exclusive use of students who are currently enrolled in the course. Content from these systems cannot be reused or distributed without written permission of the instructor and/or the copyright holder. Duplication of materials protected by copyright, without permission of the copyright holder, is a violation of the Federal copyright law, as well as a violation of SUNY copyright policy.

Disability Services Center: If you have a disability for which you are or may be requesting an accommodation, you are encouraged to contact both your instructor and the Disability Services Center, Roosevelt Hall, Room 151, or call 934- 420-2411, or 420-2607 as soon as possible this semester.

Academic Integrity Policy: Because intellectual honesty is a cornerstone of all academic and scholarly work, each member of the Farmingdale State College campus community is expected to maintain academic integrity. Farmingdale State College has developed regulations concerning academic dishonesty and integrity to protect all students and to maintain an ethical academic environment. For more information, click the updated link (<https://www.farmingdale.edu/policies/?pid=214095>) for the Academic Integrity Policy.

It is important for you to understand the concept of plagiarism. Plagiarism is intentionally representing the words, images or ideas of another as one's own in any academic exercise. This includes words, images or ideas in either print or electronic format.

Students will automatically receive a grade of zero (0) on an assignment suspected of plagiarism.

Student Code of Conduct: The President of the College and the Vice President for Student Affairs recognize the rights of designees including University Police, to enforce all regulations, policies, license agreements, laws and codes on campus. If any individual allegedly violates the laws, Student Code of Conduct or campus policies, a President's designee will institute proceedings against the offender(s). For more information on the student code of conduct, see the Code of Conduct section in the current Student Handbook, or choose Code of Conduct from the A-Z Links

(<https://www.farmingdale.edu/dean/pdf/fscstudentcodeofconduct20182019.pdf>).

Psychology Department Extra Credit Research Participation: ([www.https://farmingdale.sona-systems.com/](https://www.farmingdale.edu/sona-systems.com/)) Research experiments are a key component of the science of psychology. As a student in a psychology class, you will get the opportunity to participate in some of these experiments through the Research Participant Pool. Students who complete all of the requirements of participation for an experiment will receive up to 10 extra points on one psychology exam. You will receive additional information about this opportunity in class. Be sure to sign up right away if you want to participate! This is first come, first serve!

Missing/Late Work: Any assignments that are missed **due to an absence** can be made up provided that you personally email me. I will not reach out to you for missed work. It is your responsibility to be on top of your academic performance in this class.

Any assignments that are late will be accepted with a deduction of points.

Exams that are missed will need to be made up within 48 hours of the exam date. I will not accept any late papers.

Disagreements or conflicts: In the event of a disagreement with any of the policies outlined above, the student is directed to address the issue with the instructor. In the event that the conflict cannot be resolved, it should be taken to the Psychology Department Chairperson, Dr. Marya Carter, (934-420-2725) for review.

University Police: 934-420-2111